

Password & Account Lockout Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy defines minimum password strength and account lockout requirements for all Danotech domain accounts, enforced via Group Policy at the domain level.

2. Scope

Applies to all user accounts in the danotech.local domain. Configured centrally via the Default Domain Policy GPO, linked at the domain root, so settings apply uniformly and cannot be overridden at the OU level.

3. Configuration

Setting	Value	GPO Path
Minimum password length	12 characters	Password Policy
Password complexity	Enabled	Password Policy
Maximum password age	90 days	Password Policy
Account lockout threshold	5 invalid attempts	Account Lockout Policy
Account lockout duration	30 minutes	Account Lockout Policy
Reset lockout counter after	30 minutes	Account Lockout Policy

4. Rationale

- 12-character minimum with complexity resists brute-force and dictionary attacks while remaining passphrase-friendly.
- 90-day expiration limits the exposure window of a compromised credential that has not yet been detected.
- A 5-attempt lockout threshold balances protection against password-guessing with an acceptable rate of legitimate lockouts.

5. Administration

Changes to these settings require IT Security approval and are applied only through the Default Domain Policy GPO in Group Policy Management. Local password policy overrides on individual machines are not permitted for domain-joined systems.